

The Sentences of Sextus

15, 1-16, 28; 27, 1-34, 28

(157) is [a sign] of ignorance.

(158/159) [Love] the truth, and the lie [use] like poison.

(160) [May] the right time precede your words.

(161/162) [Speak] when it is not proper [to be silent], but [speak concerning] the things you know (only) then [when] it is fitting.

(163a) [The] untimely [word is characteristic] of an evil mind.

(163b) [When it is] proper to act, do not [use a] word.

(164a) Do not wish [to speak] first in the midst of [a crowd].

(164b) [While it is] a skill [to speak], it is also [a] skill [to be silent].

(165a) It is [better] for you to be defeated [while speaking the truth], than to be victorious [through deceit].

(165b) [He] who is victorious through [deceit] is [defeated] by the truth.

(165c) [Untrue words] are [characteristic of] evil persons.

(165d) [There has to be] a great [crisis before] the lie [is necessary].

(165e) [When there is] someone, while you speak [the truth], even if [you lie there is no sin].

(165f) Do not deceive [anyone, especially] him who needs [advice].

(165g) [If you speak] after [many (others) you will see better] what is profitable.

(166) [Faithful] is he who is first with all [good works].

(167) Wisdom leads [the soul] to the place of [God].

(168) [There is no] kinsman of the [truth except] wisdom.

(169) [It is not] possible for a [believing] nature to [become fond of] lying.

(170) A fearful [and slavish] nature will [not] be able to partake in faith.

(171a) When you are [faithful, what] it is fitting to say [is not of greater value than] the hearing.

(171b) When you [are] with believing persons, desire [to listen rather than] to speak.

(172) A pleasure-[loving] man is useless [in everything].

(173) When there is no [(accounting of) sin, do not speak] in anything (which is) from [God].

(174) [The] sins of those who are [ignorant are] the shame of those who have [taught them].

(175) Those on account of whom [the name of God] is blasphemed [are dead] before God.

(176) [A wise man is] a doer of good works after God.

(177) [May your life] confirm [your words before those who] hear.

(178) What it is [not right to do], do not even consider [doing it].

(179) [What you do not] want to [happen to you, do not do it] yourself [either].

(180) [What] it [is] shameful [to do, is also] (pp. 17-26 are missing)

(307/308) He is [a wise man who commends God] to men, [and God] thinks more highly of the wise man than his own [works].

(309) [After] God, no one is as free as the wise man.

(310) [Everything] God possesses the wise man has also.

(311/312) The wise man shares in the [kingdom] of God; an evil man does not want the foreknowledge of God to come to pass.

(313) An evil soul flees from God.

(314) Everything bad is the enemy of God.

(315) What thinks in you, say with your mind that it is man.

(316) Where your thought is, there is your goodness.

(317) Do not seek goodness in flesh.

(318) He who does [not] harm the soul neither does (so) to man.

(319) After God, honor a [wise] man, [since he] is the servant [of God].

(320) [To make] the body of your [soul] a burden is [pride], but to be able to [restrain] it [gently] when [it is necessary is] blessedness.

(321) [Do not become] guilty [of] your own death. Do not be [angry at him] who will take you [out of] (the) body and kill you.

(322) If someone brings [the wise man] out of the body wickedly, he rather [does what is] good for him, [for] he has been released from bonds.

(323) The fear of [death] grieves man because of the ignorance of the soul.

(324) <It were better) for you had [the] man-killing sword not come into being; but when it comes, say with your mind that it does not exist.

(325/326a) Someone who says, "I believe," even if he spends a long time pretending, he will not prevail, but he will fall; as your heart is, (so) will be your life.

(326b) A godly heart produces a blessed life.

(327) He who will plot evil against another, [he is] the first [...].'

(328) [Let not] an ungrateful man cause you to cease to do [good].

(329) [Do not say with] your mind that [these things] which were asked, (and) [you] gave immediately, are more valuable than [the] receiver.

(330) You will use [great] property, if you give to the [needy] willingly.

(331) Persuade a senseless brother [not to] be senseless; if he is mad, protect him.

(332/334) Strive eagerly to be victorious over every man in prudence; maintain self-sufficiency.

(333) You cannot receive understanding unless you know first that you possess <it). In everything there is again this sentence.

(335) The members of the body are a burden to those who do not use them.

(336) It is better to serve others than to make others serve you.

(337) He whom God will not bring out of (the) body, let him not burden himself.

(338) Not only do not hold an opinion which does not benefit the needy, [but also do not] listen to it.

(339) He who gives [something without] respect commits an outrage. [...].

(340) If you take on the [guardianship of] orphans, you will be [the] father of many children (and) you will be beloved of God.

(341) He [whom you serve] because of [honor, you have] served for a wage.

(342) If you [have given] that which honors you ... , [you have] given not to man, but [you have given] for your own pleasure.

(343/344) Do not [provoke] the anger of a mob. [Know, then], what is fitting for the fortunate man to [do].

(345) It is better to die [than] to darken the soul because of [the] immoderation of the belly.

(346) Say with [your] mind that the body [is] the garment of your soul; keep it, therefore, pure since it is innocent.

(347) Whatever the soul will do while it is in (the) body, it has as witnesses when it goes into judgment.

(348/349) Unclean demons do lay claim to a polluted soul; a faithful (and) good soul evil demons will not be able to hinder in the way of God.

(350) Do not give the word of God to everyone.

(351) For [those who] are corrupted by [glory] it is not assuring to [hear] about God.

(352/353) It is not a small [danger] for us to [speak the] truth about God; [do not say anything about] God before [you have] learned from [God].

(354/356) [Do not] speak with a godless person [about] God; if you are polluted [on account of] impure works, [do not] speak about God.

(357) [The] true [word] about God is [the] word of God.

(355) Speak concerning the word about God as if you were saying it in the presence of God.

(358) If first your mind is persuaded that you have been god-loving, then speak to whomever you wish about God.

(359) May your pious works precede every word about God.

(360) Do not wish to speak with a crowd about God.

(361) Be (more) sparing with a word about God (than) about a soul.

(362) It is better to dispose of a soul than to discard at random a word about God.

(363a) You conceive the body of the god-loving man, but you will not be able to rule over his speech.

(363b) The lion also rules over the body of [the wise man]; also the tyrant rules [over it] alone.

(364) If a tyrant threatens you, [then, especially], remember God.

(365) [He who speaks] the word of God [to those for whom] it is not lawful, he is [the betrayer] of God.

(366) It is better [for] you to be silent about the word of [God] than to speak recklessly.

(367/368) He who speaks lies about God is lying to God; a man who does not have anything truthful to say about [God] is abandoned by God.

(369) [It is not] possible for you to know God when you do not worship him.

(370) A man who does evil to someone will not be able to worship God.

(371) The love of man is the beginning of godliness.

(372) He who takes care of men while praying for all of them - this is the truth of God.

(373/374) It is God's business to save whom he wants; on the other hand, it is the business of the pious man to beseech God to save everyone.

(375) When you pray for something and it happens to you through God, then say with your mind that [you have . . .].

(376a) [A man who] is worthy of God, [he] is God among [men], and [he is] the son of God.

(376b) Both the great one exists and he who is next to the great one exists.

(377/378) It is better for man to be without anything than to have many things while not giving to the needy; so also you, if you pray to God, he will not give to you.

(379) If you, from your whole heart, give your bread to the hungry, the gift is small, but the willingness is great with God.

(380) He who thinks that no one is in the presence of God, he is not humble towards God.

(381) He who makes his mind like unto God as far as he is able, he is the one who honors God greatly.

(382) God does not need anything, but he rejoices over those who give to the needy.

(383) The faithful do not speak many words, but their works are numerous.

(384) It is a faithful person fond of learning who is the worker of the truth.

(385) [Adjust ... the] calamities in order that [...].

(386) [If you] do not do evil to anyone, you will not be afraid of anyone.

(387) The tyrant will not be able to take away happiness.

(388) What it is right to do, do it willingly.

(389a) What it is not right to do, do not do it in any way.

(389b) Promise everything rather than to say, "I am wise."

(390) What you do well, say with your mind that it [is] God who does it.

(391) No man who (looks) down upon the earth and upon tables is wise.

(392) The philosopher who is an outer body, he is not the one to whom it is fitting to pay respect, but (the) philosopher according to the inner man.

(393) Guard yourself from lying: there is he who deceives and there is he who is deceived.

(394/395) Know who God is, and know who is the one who thinks in you; a good man is the good work of God.

(396) They are miserable because of whom the [word] is blasphemed.

(397) Death will [not] be able to destroy (pp. 35-end are missing).